

Directed Research Project (DRP) Proposal Form

Name of the Guide: Riyaz Tayyibji

Contact information:

Email id: riyaz.tayyibji@gmail.com

Telephone no: +91 9427317699

Faculty and Program: Faculty of Architecture; Undergraduate Program in Architecture

Position: Visiting faculty

Other affiliations: Former Associate Professor at Faculty of Architecture

Title of the DRP:

A Museum in the Shade - Reevaluating Correa's Museums as a Public Spaces in the Shade

No of students the guide is accepting in this DRP: 1

Introduction about the proposed research (150 – 200 words):

A museum is understood to be a place where objects of historical, scientific, artistic, or cultural interest are studied, stored and exhibited. It becomes a corroboration for heritage, culture and the identity of the land. Post-independence, in a nation like India, there was a need to bind the populace into citizenry through their shared pride in 'their' past (Singh K, 2003). The museums of the period started with an ambition in establishing this identity, by endorsing the past of the land and reinventing its image against the Western model.

In the initial stages of post-Independent India, Charles Correa was commissioned by both central and state governments of India, to design a series of museums, with an ambition to provide civic identity to the people of the newly established states and the nation. Gandhi Samarak - Sangrahalaya (1958 - 63), Ahmedabad; Bharat Bhavan(1975 - 81), Bhopal; National Crafts Museum (1975 - 90), New Delhi and Jawahar Kala Kendra(1986 - 92, Jaipur. These projects reflect Correa's understanding and his ideas for the emerging institution of a 'museum in India'. The area of interest is generated from the hypothesis that in principle these museums have carefully designed public spaces that interact with the context. This research will focus on - the architect's programmatic understanding and its development over time with four museums in his oeuvre. Study of public spaces in the museums in relationship with their context. Essentially, the study will also look at how the buildings functioned till today's time in contrast to the architect's intention, through substantive analysis.

Aims and objectives:

This research aims to investigate Charles Correa's ideas for 'modern museums' in post-independent India, the evolution of the idea of a museum in his works and the integration of designed public spaces within the four museums in his oeuvre. Furthermore, it aims to analyze how these projects have functioned over time in comparison to the original intentions of the architect, providing valuable insights into the evolution of public spaces in Indian museums. The research sets the objectives into the following framework-

1. Research on History of Museums in India.
2. Comprehending Charles Correa's typological understanding and concepts for a 'museum' in India.
3. Understanding the contexts, aspirations and situations that gave rise to the briefs of the four museums.
 - 3.1 Who were the patrons and what were their aspirations and intentions for the projects?

3.2 Understanding, Why Correa's proposal for the type of modern museum was accepted.

4. Research on the idea of a public space in all four different contexts through the study of urban form.
5. Substantive analysis of the architect's intention through first-hand interviews and observations.
6. Inference and Conclusions.

Expected outcomes:

1. Understanding how the non-programmed component (public spaces) of a client's brief is articulated, in the cases of the four museums set in different conditions.
2. Substantive evaluation of the differences between the architect's intention and the final use of the projects, over the years.

Schedule of the DRP (weekly for 16 weeks):

Week 1 - 2: **Literature Review:** [Secondary Sources] History of Museums in India. Historical Background and Contexts of the four museums. [Primary Sources] - Research on patrons and their aspirations that led to choosing Correa and analysis of the detailed brief for each project.

Week 3 - 4: **Literature Review:** [Secondary Sources]: Understanding Correa's ideas for all four museums and his common typological understanding. Research on the idea of 'public space' in the four different contexts.

Week 9 - 12: **Visits:** [Primary Research] Substantive analysis of architect's intended vs final use through interviews and observations.

Week 13 - 16: **Final Document Structure and Presentation:** Including drawing and diagrammatic Analysis based on sources and developed Speculations.

Relevant literature:

1. Museum architecture. (1975). Unesco.
2. The Museum is National (Article) by Kavita Singh.
3. Correa, C. (2012). A place in the shade: The new landscape and other essays. Hatje Cantz.
4. Khan, H.-U., Correa, C., & Cantacuzino, S. (1987). Charles Correa: Architect in India. Butterworth.
5. Corsane, G. (2010). Heritage, museums and galleries: An introductory reader. Routledge.

How is this DRP aligned with the long-term research direction of the guide?

The guide, Riyaz Tayyibji, has been involved in the research of modern architecture and its processes of production, material technologies and construction methods. He has been deeply involved in the research of the buildings built by M.K. Gandhi. He has also recently been researching the Museum as an institution in post independent India. This research aligns with all three of these trajectories of his research.

Student expenses:

None

External funding:

None

Only for funded DRPs:

None

Recommended by:

DRP Committee
(Program Chair & Faculty in-charge)

Approved by:

Dean, Faculty of Architecture